APPIAN INTERVIEW EXPERIENCE

Role: Software Engineer Intern

The selection process consisted of four rounds. This included an online coding round and three in person interview rounds.

Online Coding Round:
The test was conducted on **Glider AI**, which was extremely strict in its proctoring. It monitored both video and audio, with face and sound detection. The platform continuously flagged students even if they looked down for more than 10 seconds while typing, so maintaining proper posture and awareness was necessary.

Three coding questions were asked:

1. **Insert and Merge Schedules** – Given a list of schedules and a new schedule, insert the new schedule in the correct place such that non-conflicting schedules remain unchanged, while conflicting schedules are merged. Return the final list of non-conflicting schedules.

2. **Find Missing and Duplicate Number with Team Validation** – Given an array of size *n* containing numbers from 1 to *n* with exactly one number missing and one duplicated, find both. Then, using a team (array of tuples), determine:

   - If both missing and duplicate numbers occur in the same team(tuple) → return **valid**
   - If no such team(tuple) exists → return **invalid**
   - If more than one such team(tuple) exists → return **multiple teams**

3. **First and Last Occurrence** – Though worded in a complex way, the question essentially asked for finding the first and last occurrence of a given element in an array. This was straightforward.

Technical Interview – Round 1:
This round went smoothly, and the interviewers were very approachable.

- Began with questions from my resume, including all listed projects, work experience, and extracurricular activities.

- Asked about my favourite programming language — I chose C++, after which I was given:

Problem 1 (C++): Given a string, find the positions of vowels and reverse only the vowels' positions without altering other characters.

- Then moved to Java:

Problem 2 (Java): Write a simple Java class on paper and explain OOP concepts such as interfaces, inheritance (including all types), and their use cases.

- Follow-up DSA discussion on which data structures I used in my projects and why they were beneficial in their respective contexts.

Technical + Behavioural Interview – Round 2:
A relaxed conversation that blended technical and behavioural questions.

- Personal questions about my goals, the type of professional I aspire to be, and my learning approaches.
- Situation-based questions: lessons learned from experiences, difficulties faced when learning new technologies, and how I addressed them.
- Discussion on my areas of interest and how I plan to develop them.
- Ended with an opportunity for me to ask questions, and the interviewer offered constructive feedback on my answers and approach.

HR Interview – Round 3:
This round lasted ~15 minutes.

- Questions about my 10th and 12th scores, entrance examinations I had attempted, and my choice of engineering as a career path.
- Discussion on college coursework, followed by a simple DBMS question on implementing many-to-many relationships.
- Ended with me asking questions to the interviewer.

Key Takeaways:

- Coding questions were primarily based on string manipulation and could be solved without excessive stress.
- Be confident about the skills mentioned in your resume and prepare solid, relevant projects.

- Think aloud while solving problems so interviewers can evaluate your thought process.
- Revise basics in DBMS, OOPS, and problem-solving techniques.
- Learn about the company beforehand and ask thoughtful, relevant questions.

Happy to help – All the very best!

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